



**DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN**  
**SESSION 2022-23**  
**HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION**

**CLASS: VIII**  
**SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET B)**

**FULL MARKS: 80**  
**TIME: 2 HOURS**

**General Instructions:**

- The question paper consists of five printed pages.
- Answers should be to the point.
- Copy the question numbers carefully before answering the questions.
- Marks will be deducted for spelling errors.
- Writing time is not included in the reading time

**SECTION A**

**I. Choose the most appropriate option:** **[10]**

- a) He gripped his brother's arm \_\_\_\_ he should be trampled by the mob. (Fill in the blank with a suitable conjunction)
- i. or                      ii. when                      iii. lest                      iv. if
- b) The children \_\_\_\_\_ playing all day. (Fill in the blank with the suitable Tense form)
- i. has been                      ii. are                      iii. have been                      iv. would be
- c) Choose the sentence with the correct position of Adverbs.
- i. The teacher was greatly impressed by the student's performance.
- ii. The teacher was impressed greatly by the student's performance.
- iii. Greatly was the teacher impressed by the student's performance.
- iv. The teacher was impressed by the student's performance greatly.
- d) Choose the sentence with the correct position of Adverb.
- i. She accepted the offer reluctantly.
- ii. Reluctantly she accepted the offer.
- iii. She accepted reluctantly the offer.
- iv. She reluctantly accepted the offer.
- e) I don't want anyone to disturb me (Change the voice of the given sentence)
- i. No one should disturb me.
- ii. I don't want to be disturbed.
- iii. I should not be disturbed by anyone.
- iv. I don't want to disturb anyone.
- f) He taught me that good deeds \_\_\_\_\_ never lost. (Fill in the blank with a correct Tense form)
- i. were                      ii. will be                      iii. are                      iv. would be

- g) I wondered why they hadn't invited me. (Change the voice of the given sentence)
- I wondered why they haven't invited me.
  - I wonder why they haven't invited me.
  - I wondered why they hadn't invited.
  - I wondered why I hadn't been invited.
- h) The defence lawyer failed to acquit his son in a case. (Identify the figure of speech)
- Irony
  - Metaphor
  - Personification
  - Simile
- i) It was very cruel on the part of the owner to\_\_\_\_\_ the old, sick dog. (Fill in the blank with a suitable Phrasal verb)
- pass off
  - cast down
  - give over
  - come round
- j) I told her to leave\_\_\_\_\_I was very busy. (Fill in the blank with a suitable conjunction)
- if
  - for
  - though
  - while

### SECTION B

II. Write a composition (350-400 words) on any one of the following:

[20]

- Describe your favourite time of the day. What are the sights, sounds, smells and feelings that you associate with your favourite time? Why do you like this part of the day better than the others?
- 'School days are the happiest days of our lives'. Express your views either for or against this statement.
- Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



III. Select any ONE of the following:

[10]

- a) As a responsible citizen, you wish to start an old clothes collection drive. These clothes are to be donated to an orphanage nearby. Write a letter to your friend informing him of your plan and requesting him to help you in this mission.
- b) Write a letter to the editor of a local newspaper telling him/her what you think about global warming, its effects and what people should do to prevent it from getting worse.

IV. Write a Notice on the following topic.

[5]

Your school has decided to host the regional level basketball tournament. Draft a Notice for your school Notice board inviting all the children of your school to participate in the tournament.

V. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

My husband Pele and I were staying in a holiday house overlooking the beautiful, lush rainforests of Indonesia. The glass walls framed a fine view across the Bagon Valley to what had been the summer palace of President Suharto. The first morning we strolled up a winding pathway, heading to the main building for breakfast. But once we arrived at the dining room, I realized we'd forgotten our money, so I volunteered to run back to the house. Making my way down the path, I turned the last corner only to find a giant bird, similar to an emu, standing outside our front door. "Hey baby, what are you doing?" I cooed, moving slowly so as not to frighten it. Having a deep, abiding fascination with all creatures great and small, I wanted a closer look. This was my first mistake. As I came within a few meters, he took a big breath and let out a nasty hiss, stopping me in my tracks. "That's not very friendly," I said, clueless. He hissed again and I promptly made the second mistake of turning and running, instead of backing away slowly. As I rounded the corner, I heard his razor-sharp claws scrabbling on the cobblestones. "Oh!" His steps sounded like a drum as they hit the ground, quickly coming too close for comfort. I suddenly changed direction and headed into the trees. Dodged in and out of the foliage. I hoped my tactic would fool him. A crash behind me indicated no such luck. Jumping over a small bush, I found myself out in the open and not far from the dining room. Picking up speed, I bolted over the plants and rockeries surrounding the perimeter and dashed through the gate. When I turned to close it, the bird was nowhere to be seen. I didn't realize it at that time, but I had just come face to face with a cassowary, a bird also found in Australia's north Queensland rainforests. Cassowaries weigh 55 kilos or more, stand about 180 centimeters tall and have saber-like toenails that can open a human from chin to toe like a zipper and kill humans. "What's wrong?" Pele asked as I stumbled back into the dining room. "A big bird chased me all the way from the house," I replied. "What?" he asked incredulously.

“You’re scared of a bird?” “It’s as big as me and very mean,” I said in a rather sulky voice. “Oh, all right,” he laughed. “I’ll come with you.” Much to Pele’s amusement, I stayed behind him on the path and held onto the back of his shirt as we approached the corner of the house. “See! There it is. Look at the size of the thing!” Pele chuckled at the hysteria in my voice. “It’s all right,” he soothed. Calmly and confidently, he walked toward the cassowary. “Shoo! Go on, get out,” he said. He made actions with his arms as if it were a pigeon on a window ledge. The response of the cassowary was the same as before: a big hiss and a step forward. “Hmm,” said Pele and stopped, not so sure of himself. He tried again. “Go on.” The cassowary then ran a few paces at us, hissing aggressively, so we quickly retreated around a corner of the house. Pele picked up a rock the size of his hand and threw it hard, hitting the bird squarely in the chest. It didn’t budge. “What are we going to do?” I pleaded. This time, Pele picked up a cane chair. “Stay behind and I’ll keep him back. When we get to the door, open it.” Again, I held on to the back of his shirt and we started towards the door. This greatly displeased the already annoyed cassowary. Charging at us he ripped at the chair with those lethal claws. Pele stopped to steady the chair – and possibly his resolve. Pele threw the chair at the bird and slammed the door shut. Ducking the flying cane, the bird ran straight at the glass wall, only to bounce off. But it didn’t slow down at all. Pecking and scratching at the glass, it continued the assault with a sickening ferocity. It was another 15 minutes before the bird weakened and slowed its attack. Thirty minutes later, we quietly opened the door and crept back to the main building.

a) Give the meanings of the following words as used in the passage. One-word answers or short phrases will be accepted. [3]

- i) strolled
- ii) fascination
- iii) foliage

b) Answer the following questions briefly in your own words.

- i) What was Pele’s wife’s first mistake when she saw the bird? [2]
- ii) What was the lady’s third mistake? [2]
- iii) When Pele’s wife realized that there was ‘no such luck’, what did she do? [2]
- iv) Describe the Cassowary. [2]
- v) Give a title to the passage and give a reason to justify your choice. [1]

c) In not more than 50 words describe how the couple escaped the cassowary and returned to their room. [8]

**VI. Fill in the blanks with the appropriate form of the word given in brackets. [4]**

Mr Bose 1 (live) in this house since 1970. Now, the time 2 (come) to leave this house and 3 (settle) abroad. His son 4 (settle) in England and 5 (want) his father to join him. Mr. Bose 6 (sad) and doesn't want to 7 (go) but his son refuses to 8 (listen)

**VII. Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using and, but or *so*. [4]**

- a) I smelt something burning. I rushed to the kitchen immediately.
- b) Mira gave me a cake. I was unable to eat it.
- c) The earthquake was mild. There were cracks on the road.
- d) Take care of your parents. It is your prime duty.

**VIII. Do as directed: [7]**

- a) We heard the noise. We rushed to the spot. (Begin: No sooner did .....)
- b) His opinions have been strongly criticised by the editor. (Change to Active Voice)
- c) Some girls were helping the wounded woman. (Change the voice of the sentence)
- d) I have finished painting the house. (Use the adverb 'almost' correctly)
- e) I can hear your whisper from miles away. (Identify the figure of speech)
- f) The trekkers were completely \_\_\_\_\_ after the expedition. (Fill in the blank with a suitable Phrasal verb)
- g) Mother says, "I like to take a walk on the beach during the summer months."  
(Rewrite the sentence in Reported speech)